

Participant Information and Consent Sheet

Study title

London Underground "What-If" Simulator - User Study

Who is conducting this study?

This study is being carried out by a final-year undergraduate group (Sinead Parkinson – sop3@kent.ac.uk, Sattyaj Paul – sp972@kent.ac.uk, Saf Sikder – ss2766@kent.ac.uk, Jaden Toon – jt681@kent.ac.uk) as part of the COMP6030 Final Year Project module in the School of Computing at the University of Kent. The project is supervised by Peter Rodgers.

What is the purpose of the study?

We have built an interactive web application that lets users plan routes on the London Underground and explore "what-if" scenarios, such as closing a station or simulating a disruption, to see how it affects their journey. The purpose of this study is to evaluate how usable, useful and clear the system is and to gather feedback that will help us improve it. The results will be used only for academic purposes as part of our final-year project (report, corpus and viva).

What will taking part involve?

If you choose to take part, you will be asked to use the simulator to complete a small number of short navigation tasks and then answer a questionnaire about your experience. The questionnaire asks for some non-identifying background information (for example, your age range, gender, and how familiar you are with the London Underground) followed by rating-scale and open-text questions about the system. The whole session should take approximately 10-15 minutes.

Do I have to take part?

No. Participation is entirely voluntary. You may decline to take part, skip any question you do not wish to answer and stop at any point before submitting your responses without giving a reason and without any consequences. Because responses are submitted anonymously, once you submit the questionnaire it is not possible to identify and withdraw your individual responses afterwards. Please only submit if you are happy for your answers to be used.

Who can take part?

You must be 18 years of age or older to take part. The questionnaire begins with an age-verification question and anyone under 18 is directed out of the study and their responses are not collected.

What data do you collect and how is it kept confidential?

Your responses are anonymous. We do not ask for your name, email address, or any other information that could directly identify you. The background information we collect (age range,

gender, familiarity, technical background) is used only to describe our participant group in aggregate. We will not attempt to identify any individual from their responses.

The questionnaire is hosted on Google Forms and responses are stored in the associated Google account belonging to the project group. Data is accessible only to the project team and our supervisor and to the module markers as part of normal assessment. Aggregated and anonymised results may appear in our project report, corpus and viva. Anonymised data will be retained until the project has been marked and the assessment process concluded, after which it will be deleted.

This study is conducted in line with the University of Kent's guidance on research involving human participants and applicable data-protection law (UK GDPR / Data Protection Act 2018).

Who do I contact with questions?

If you have any questions about the study, please contact Sinead Parkinson sop3@kent.ac.uk.

Consent

By continuing with the questionnaire, you confirm that:

- I confirm that I am 18 years of age or older.
- I have read and understood the information above.
- I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I may stop at any time before submitting.
- I understand that my responses are anonymous and will be used for academic research purposes only.
- I agree to take part in this study.

(In our questionnaire, age verification and consent were captured as required confirmation questions at the start of the form; participants who did not confirm were marked ineligible and their responses were not collected.)